

KONYI DIGITAL MARKETING STORE

PRIVATE EDITORIAL EDITION



# The Small Business Marketing Playbook

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A Practical Guide to Getting Seen, Trusted, and Chosen

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A practical guide for owners who want clearer marketing and useful action.

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PRIVATE REVIEW DRAFT | OWNER APPROVAL REQUIRED

# A private draft for careful review

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*This private review edition was prepared for the author's reading, editing, pricing, and approval. It must not be sold, shared publicly, or presented as the final published edition until the owner has reviewed and approved it.*

## Educational disclaimer

This book provides general educational information about marketing and content planning. It is not legal, financial, tax, advertising compliance, or professional business advice. Apply the ideas with judgement, check the rules that apply to your market, and seek qualified advice when a decision carries material risk.

Examples are teaching devices. They describe possible situations and do not claim results, client histories, testimonials, awards, or guarantees. Replace them with evidence from your own work before using them in public marketing.

## A note on the language

The book uses British English and keeps the focus on useful decisions a small business owner can make with limited time. You do not need a large team or a complicated marketing stack to complete the exercises. You do need a clear offer, honest observation, and a willingness to review what customers actually do.

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# Contents

*Use this as a route through the book, or start with the chapter that matches the decision in front of you. The worksheets at the end turn each idea into a working document.*

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# How to use this book

Start with the chapter that describes the decision you are avoiding. If people do not understand what you do, begin with positioning. If your marketing is busy but enquiries are weak, begin with the offer or conversion path. If you are unsure what to publish, begin with the content plan.

Keep a working document beside you. Write your actual audience, offer, phrases, proof, and next step rather than copying the examples. The value comes from making the ideas specific to the business you run and the people you want to help.

Treat each exercise as a draft. A clear sentence becomes clearer after you use it in a real conversation, a sales page, an email, or a social post. Revisit the worksheets at the end after the 30-day plan and mark what you learned.

**A useful reading rhythm**

Read one chapter, complete its exercise before moving on, and keep a short record of what changed. Marketing becomes easier to improve when your decisions, messages, and customer responses sit in one place.

# Introduction

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Marketing can become a pile of disconnected jobs: post more often, refresh the website, try another platform, design a new lead magnet, send a newsletter, and check the numbers. A small business owner has limited hours, so a pile of jobs quickly becomes a source of guilt rather than a plan.

A useful marketing system starts with a few connected decisions. You decide who you serve and what they need to understand. You shape one offer that gives the right person a clear reason to act. You use their language to explain the problem. You publish useful ideas that build familiarity and trust. You gather proof that shows how the work looks in practice. You then guide interested people towards one sensible next step.

This sequence does not remove judgement. It gives judgement somewhere to work. You can choose the channel, budget, pace, and style that suit your business. The sequence helps you see whether a weak result comes from a vague message, an offer that needs work, thin proof, or a path that asks for too much too soon.

The aim of this book is a working marketing foundation you can improve. Read slowly, write plainly, and choose actions you can keep doing when the week becomes busy. Consistency grows from clarity and repeatable decisions, not from trying to appear everywhere at once.

# Positioning: become easier to choose

*A clear place in the customer's mind gives every later message a job.*

Positioning is the meaning people attach to your business when they compare it with other choices. It answers a practical question: why should this person pay attention to you for this problem? A position is not a slogan. It is a useful point of view about who you help, what you help them do, and the kind of experience they can expect.

Small businesses often describe themselves by listing everything they can do. A photographer may offer portraits, events, product work, editing, prints, and workshops. A consultant may mention strategy, training, research, planning, and implementation. The list may be accurate, yet a potential customer still has to work out where the business fits their immediate need.

Start by choosing a primary audience for the next season of marketing. This does not mean refusing every other customer. It means giving your public message a centre. Name the situation they are in, the problem they want to solve, and the outcome they can recognise. Specific context creates a stronger signal than a wide category.

A useful positioning sentence has four parts: this is for a particular group, who are dealing with a recognisable situation, and it helps them reach a clear outcome through a distinctive approach. Your approach may be speed, patience, specialist knowledge, a local connection, a careful process, or a way of making a complicated decision easier.

Choose a boundary you can defend. If you serve everyone, the message tends to become a collection of safe words. If you choose a real boundary, the right people can recognise themselves and the wrong people can move on without wasting your time. You can widen the boundary later when the core message has earned its place.

Test your position in conversation. Say it to a customer, colleague, or trusted person and ask what they think you do, who they think it is for, and what outcome they heard. Their answer shows the meaning your words create, which is more useful than judging the sentence alone.

## Example

A local bookkeeping service could describe itself as offering accounts, payroll, tax support, and reporting. A clearer position might be: 'We help independent shop owners keep their monthly numbers understandable, current, and ready for the decisions they need to make.' The second version gives the audience, context, and value a place to meet.

### Chapter takeaways

- ☐ Choose one primary audience for the next season of communication.
- ☐ Describe the situation and outcome in words that a customer would use.
- ☐ Name the part of your approach that makes the work feel different or easier.
- ☐ Test the sentence in conversation and listen to what people repeat back.

### Try this before the next chapter

Write three versions of your positioning sentence. Remove broad claims and replace them with a customer, a situation, and an outcome.

Ask one real person to explain what they think you do after hearing the best version. Record their exact words.

# One simple offer: give attention somewhere to land

*A focused offer turns a broad capability into a decision a customer can understand.*

An offer is the shaped way someone buys a result from you. It includes the outcome, the scope, the process, the price or pricing conversation, and the next step. A service list tells people what you can do. An offer helps them decide whether this is the right way to solve the problem they have now.

Choose one offer to lead with for the next 30 days. It could be a fixed project, a paid consultation, a starter package, a workshop, or a clear first stage of a larger service. The best starting offer is specific enough to explain and useful enough to create progress, while leaving room to learn from the people who buy it.

Describe the change before describing the activities. Customers may need a plan, a review, a set of designs, or a series of sessions, but they usually care about what those activities help them understand, complete, decide, or improve. Keep the activities in the explanation so the scope feels real. Let the outcome give the offer its meaning.

Set a boundary around the offer. Say who it is for, what is included, what is not included, how long the work takes, what the customer needs to provide, and what happens after delivery. Boundaries reduce uncertainty for both sides. They also make your marketing more concrete because you have something definite to show.

Make the first step proportionate to the decision. A customer who is still learning may be ready for a short diagnostic conversation or a useful guide. Someone with an urgent problem may be ready to book the full project. Your offer ladder can have stages, but each stage should make sense on its own and should not hide the real cost or commitment.

Review the offer after a few conversations. Notice the questions people ask, the part they value, and the point where they hesitate. Those signals can improve the wording, scope, or delivery. An offer becomes clearer through use, not through endless private editing.

## Example

A freelance web designer might lead with a broad list of website services. A simple offer could be 'A two-week homepage clarity sprint for service businesses with an existing site that attracts visits but leaves visitors unsure what to do next.' The scope, audience, and decision are easier to picture.

### Chapter takeaways

- ☐ Lead with one offer for one season of marketing.
- ☐ Explain the outcome, scope, boundaries, timing, and next step.
- ☐ Let the activities support the outcome rather than replace it.
- ☐ Use customer questions and hesitation as evidence for the next revision.

### Try this before the next chapter

Fill in this sentence: 'I help [person in situation] achieve [outcome] through [offer], delivered over [time].'  
Then list what is included and excluded.

Write the smallest fair first step for a person who needs more confidence before buying the main offer.

# Customer language: borrow the words people already use

*Marketing becomes easier to understand when the customer does not have to translate it.*

Customer language is the record of how people describe their situation, hopes, doubts, and decisions. It is more than a collection of catchy phrases. It helps you understand what the problem feels like before someone labels it as the service you sell. This is where many strong messages begin.

Listen in places where customers explain themselves without trying to help your marketing. Review enquiries, emails, support conversations, consultation notes, product reviews, community discussions, and the questions people ask before they buy. Look for repeated nouns and verbs. Notice what they say they tried, what they fear will happen, and what would make a choice feel sensible.

Sort the language into a few useful groups: current situation, desired change, frustration, obstacle, decision criteria, and words that describe a successful result. Keep the original wording in one column and your interpretation in another. The separation matters because your interpretation can be wrong, while the original phrase is an honest piece of evidence.

Use the language with care. You can echo a customer's words without pretending to quote them publicly or implying a testimonial. If a phrase carries personal information, remove identifying detail. Customer language should make the message more relevant, not turn a private moment into marketing material.

Look for the gap between the problem a customer names and the problem they are ready to pay to solve. Someone may say they need more followers, yet the decision they want may be a steadier flow of enquiries. Your job is to understand the desired business change while respecting the words that lead you there.

Review your language bank every month. Remove phrases that sound clever but no longer match real conversations. Add questions that keep appearing. Over time, your website, content, emails, and sales calls can share one understandable vocabulary.

## Example

A tradesperson may hear, 'I keep putting off calling because I do not know how long the disruption will last.' The useful message may focus on a clear time estimate, a tidy work plan, and updates during the job. 'Quality workmanship' is less specific than the concern the customer actually expressed.

### Chapter takeaways

- ☐ Collect language from real customer conversations and questions.
- ☐ Separate the original words from your interpretation.
- ☐ Listen for the business decision behind a surface request.
- ☐ Protect privacy and use customer language as evidence, not decoration.

### Try this before the next chapter

Write down five exact phrases you have heard recently. Sort them into situation, desired change, concern, and decision criteria.

Rewrite one page or post using the customer's words. Ask a reader which sentence feels most familiar and why.

# A repeatable content plan: publish with a purpose

*A useful content rhythm gives people reasons to remember, trust, and contact you.*

A content plan is a set of useful conversations you can repeat, not a demand to invent a new performance every day. Its job is to help the right people understand their situation, see your way of thinking, and recognise the next step. The plan should support your offer and positioning rather than sit beside them as a separate project.

Build the plan around four jobs. Teach something that helps the audience make progress. Clarify a decision where people often feel unsure. Show how your process works. Invite the right person to take the next step. These jobs can appear in different formats, but the purpose keeps the content connected.

Choose a primary channel you can maintain. A channel is useful when the people you want to reach use it and when you can show up there without resenting the work. Adapt the idea for other channels only after the main version is clear. One useful weekly idea can become a short post, an email, a conversation prompt, and a longer explanation.

Give each piece a single point. A post that tries to teach five lessons, announce three services, tell a personal story, and answer every objection becomes difficult to follow. Choose one question and answer it well. End with an invitation that matches the reader's stage, such as saving the idea, replying with a question, reading the guide, or booking the first step.

Create a light production rhythm. You might collect questions on Monday, draft one substantial idea on Tuesday, adapt it on Wednesday, publish on Thursday, and review responses on Friday. Your rhythm can be different. The useful part is the handoff from observation to idea to publication to learning.

Review quality through response, not vanity. Look for thoughtful replies, direct questions, useful conversations, visits to the offer, and people who can explain what you help with. Reach and impressions may provide context, but they should not decide the whole plan.

## Example

A wedding florist could plan one weekly idea around a real planning question: choosing flowers for a small venue, protecting a budget, preparing for seasonal availability, or making a ceremony arrangement work twice. Each idea teaches, shows judgement, and can point to a consultation without turning every post into a sales pitch.

### Chapter takeaways

- ☐ Give content a job linked to understanding, trust, or action.
- ☐ Choose a channel and rhythm you can maintain.
- ☐ Keep one clear point and one proportionate next step in each piece.
- ☐ Review meaningful responses and conversations alongside reach.

### Try this before the next chapter

List ten questions your customers ask before buying. Group them into teaching, decision, process, and next-step topics.

Choose one question and plan one main piece, two short adaptations, and one invitation that leads to your offer.

# Honest proof: let the work speak clearly

*Proof reduces uncertainty when it shows what happened, how it happened, and what the work involved.*

People want to know whether an offer is credible for their situation. Proof helps them make that judgement. It can include a clear process, a useful demonstration, a before-and-after comparison where the change can be supported, a customer comment given with permission, a sample, or a transparent explanation of what the work includes.

Start with the evidence you already own. Review completed projects, approved deliverables, questions you solved, decisions you helped someone make, and moments where the process became easier. You do not need to turn every piece of work into a dramatic story. Small, specific evidence often answers a real concern more effectively than a grand claim.

Describe the context and the contribution. Say what the situation was, what you did, and what changed in observable terms. Avoid claiming that your work caused every positive outcome when other factors were involved. Honest language can still be confident: explain the work you completed and the decision it supported.

Ask permission before using customer material. Confirm the wording, context, name or anonymity, and where the proof will appear. Keep a record. If permission is not available, turn the learning into a general example without suggesting that a real customer endorsed the claim.

Proof can also be a demonstration. Show a review checklist, a small part of your process, a sample decision, a planning template, or a short walkthrough. Demonstrations let people assess the quality of your thinking before they commit. They also give your content plan something concrete to publish.

Keep a proof file and update it after delivery. Add the original problem, the work completed, the customer's own words where permission exists, and the limitations of the result. This creates a trustworthy source for future pages, proposals, conversations, and content.

## Example

A copywriter can show a before-and-after paragraph, explain the decision behind the changes, and state what the client approved. If a measurable commercial result is not available, the copywriter can still demonstrate clearer structure, a more direct call to action, or a message that reflects customer language without inventing an outcome.

### Chapter takeaways

- ☐ Use specific evidence that answers a real customer uncertainty.
- ☐ Describe context, contribution, and observable change without overclaiming.
- ☐ Get permission before using customer names, words, or work.
- ☐ Keep demonstrations and process evidence alongside testimonials.

### Try this before the next chapter

Create a proof inventory with five completed pieces of work. For each one, write the situation, your contribution, the evidence available, and what you cannot claim.

Turn one process step into a short public demonstration that helps a potential customer judge your approach.

# One conversion path: make the next step obvious

*A clear route helps interested people move from attention to a sensible conversation or purchase.*

A conversion path is the sequence between noticing your marketing and taking the next meaningful action. It may be short: a post, an offer page, and a booking form. It may include an email or a consultation first. The path should feel like a natural continuation of the promise you made, not a sudden demand for a large commitment.

Choose one primary action for the offer you are leading with. Examples include booking a paid consultation, requesting a proposal, buying a starter product, joining a workshop, or sending a question. Supporting actions can exist, but one action should be easiest to find and easiest to explain.

Make the destination repeat the message. If a post promises a clear way to plan a first campaign, the next page should explain that planning offer rather than send the reader to a generic home page. Carry the audience, problem, outcome, scope, and proof through the path so the reader does not have to start again.

Reduce uncertainty at the point of action. Explain what happens after someone clicks, how long the first step takes, what they need to prepare, what it costs or how pricing works, and when they can expect a reply. A clear process is part of the offer. It allows the right person to say yes with fewer unanswered questions.

Follow up with respect. If someone asks a question, answer the question before pushing for a sale. If someone requests information, deliver it and explain the next useful choice. A follow-up message can be brief and helpful. It should never create pressure by implying a deadline or scarcity that does not exist.

Review the path as a visitor. Click every link, read every instruction, test the form, and check the mobile view. Then ask a person who does not know the business to tell you what they think will happen next. Their uncertainty is a design task, not a reason to blame the visitor.

## Example

A marketing adviser could lead from a practical post to a page for a 45-minute message review. The page explains who it suits, what the owner brings, what is reviewed, what they leave with, the price, and the booking step. The adviser can offer a larger project later, but the first route remains clear.

### Chapter takeaways

- ☐ Choose one primary action for the offer you are promoting.
- ☐ Carry the same promise and language through each step.
- ☐ Answer practical questions before asking for commitment.
- ☐ Test the path on mobile and with someone unfamiliar with the business.

### Try this before the next chapter

Draw your current path from first attention to first purchase or conversation. Circle every point where the visitor has to guess.

Rewrite the primary call to action so it says what the person gets and what happens next.

# The 30-day action plan

Use the plan as a steady sequence rather than a daily performance test. Set aside a focused block of time, complete the smallest useful version of the task, and leave evidence of what you decided. If a day gets missed, continue with the next action.

## Days 1 to 3 | choose the centre

Write the audience, situation, outcome, and approach for the offer you want to lead with. Read the sentence aloud and remove words that could describe almost any business.

- Name one primary audience for the next 30 days.
- Write one positioning sentence and one offer sentence.
- List three boundaries that keep the offer clear.

## Days 4 to 7 | listen before publishing

Review recent enquiries, notes, emails, and conversations. Copy useful phrases exactly, then sort them into situation, desired change, concern, and decision criteria. Keep private details out of the public version.

- Collect at least ten customer phrases.
- Write five questions that deserve a useful answer.
- Choose one phrase that should appear in your offer explanation.

## Days 8 to 14 | shape the message

Draft the offer page or one-page description. Explain the outcome, scope, process, boundaries, timing, price or pricing conversation, and first step. Create one educational piece that answers a common question.

- Draft one main piece and two short adaptations.
- Add one process demonstration or sample.
- Ask a reader what they think the next step is.

## Days 15 to 21 | build proof and a path

Create a proof inventory and choose two pieces of evidence you can use with permission. Then map the route from a post, email, or conversation to the primary action. Repair the points where a visitor must guess.

- Record context, contribution, and evidence for two examples.
- Check links, forms, timing, and mobile layout.
- Write a helpful follow-up message for people who ask for details.

## Days 22 to 30 | publish, observe, improve

Use the same positioning and offer language for a full week. Pay attention to questions, replies, clicks, conversations, and objections. Make one measured change at a time so you can tell what you learned.

- Publish or send the planned pieces.
- Record meaningful responses without inventing a success story.
- Choose the one change you will carry into the next month.

# Positioning sentence

*Write a sentence that makes the audience, situation, outcome, and approach easy to recognise.*

**This is for...**

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**They are dealing with...**

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**They want to...**

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**We help through...**

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**The complete sentence is...**

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# One offer card

*Use this page to make one offer specific enough to explain and deliver.*

**The offer is for...**

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**The customer leaves with...**

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**Included work and boundaries...**

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**Timing, price, or pricing conversation...**

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**The first step is...**

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# Customer language bank

*Record real words, then separate what was said from what you think it means.*

**Exact phrase...**

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**Situation behind the phrase...**

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**Desired change...**

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**Concern or objection...**

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**A respectful message using this language...**

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# Content and proof checklist

*Plan a small set of useful pieces that teach, demonstrate, and guide action.*

**Question to answer...**

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**Process or sample to show...**

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**Evidence I can use with permission...**

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**Primary call to action...**

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**Response I will watch for...**

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# Conclusion

A small business can build a steady marketing practice from a few connected choices. Choose who you are speaking to, make the offer understandable, listen to the language people use, publish useful answers, show honest evidence, and guide the next step.

You will learn more by using a clear draft than by protecting an unfinished idea. Let the market give you questions. Let the questions improve the offer. Let the offer give the content a purpose. Then keep the route simple enough to maintain when the business asks for your attention elsewhere.

**A final review question**

What is the next customer-facing action you can make clearer this week? Write it down, make the change, and watch for the response before adding another tactic.

# Author note

Ernest Konyi Chie writes practical resources for business owners who want clearer communication and useful progress. This draft is designed to be read with a notebook open and revised through real work.

Before publication, review every example, exercise, design choice, and catalogue detail against the audience you intend to serve. Keep the ideas that help you make the next useful move.

## Private review reminder

This file is an owner review draft. Check the manuscript, examples, design, metadata, price, and delivery file before approving any future public edition.